agreed to be my travelling companion and we shall set off as soon as possible probably by the Black Sea to Trebizonde and thence to Tabriz by land. My companion is a fine young professieur I like him much.

I have been kindly received by both the Dutch and Austrian ambassadors and by all the English merchants here but there is but little society, most of the people having left for the present. We appear perfectly secure here I have been over all Constantinople and the surrounding country in company with an Austrian officer and Engineer. I must leave description for my next letter which I shall send by the next post which leaves about the same time as we expect to do.

I sent by the Skylark Captn. Davis bound from Smirna to London a small present for all of you which I hope you will accept rather as coming from Turkey than for the value of the things contained. There are 4 pairs slippers with the outer shoes to fit as near as I can guess my Father, Edward, Joe and George, 6 common Turkish purses and one of a better kind and 1 Doz of Oil of Roses in different bottles some in the shape of an opera glass others pipes boots etc. If I can find any thing worth sending here I will procure it.

Since writing the above we have had the insurpassable pleasure to receive a kind letter from Sadik mentioning his arrival and that if possible he will send a Tartar to us with every thing necessary for our proceeding with the goods. This however cannot be at present as it is impossible the goods should come up here without the presence of a British Ambassador therefore we are of opinion that my journey should be prosecuted. Sadik's letter is full of good hopes and kind sentiments. God grant they may be fullfilled.

In Sadik's letter he mentioned that his friends there would be glad to receive me and to place me in such a situation of course military as I was fitted for.

[Syeed Khan to Henry Burgess.] *Constantinople, June 10, 1828*

I had only time to offer you a hasty postscript to Mr. Willsonnes Letter by the last post, but fearing it might not be sufficiently explanatory respecting your son Charles I beg to repeat that part of it which relates to his military appointment in the Persian army which is as follows. — He will receive 18,000 piastres per ann. as Lieutenant, House in Garrison and Tents in Camp, Forage for three Horses all the Year round, Baggage to be carried and a Set of Carpets. He will also get 9000 piastres for the Expenses of his Journey out, but he must at least agree to serve the Prince[5] for five years — after which time if he chooses to go home, he will get another 9000 piastres to take him home, to make all this sure I had procured a Firmin for him, which I have enclosed in a Letter to him to await his arrival at Tabreez. I shall be very happy if this proves satisfactory both

[5] Abbas Mirza, oldest son of Fath Ali Shah.

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